01 / DEBATE ROOM

# Set a bounded discussion question.

This course practises building and examining arguments. The issue is fictional: should an imagined reading group use one shared text or offer several choices?

The aim is to make reasoning visible, not to declare a universally correct policy or evaluate a real group. Keep the discussion within the stated exercise.

## Issue / scope / decision not being made

Working record: Write the discussion question and one real-world conclusion it cannot settle. Keep your first attempt and your revised version so the change remains visible.

**Issue**

Write your issue here.

**scope**

Write your scope here.

**decision not being made**

Write your decision not being made here.

*Write the discussion question and one real-world conclusion it cannot settle.*

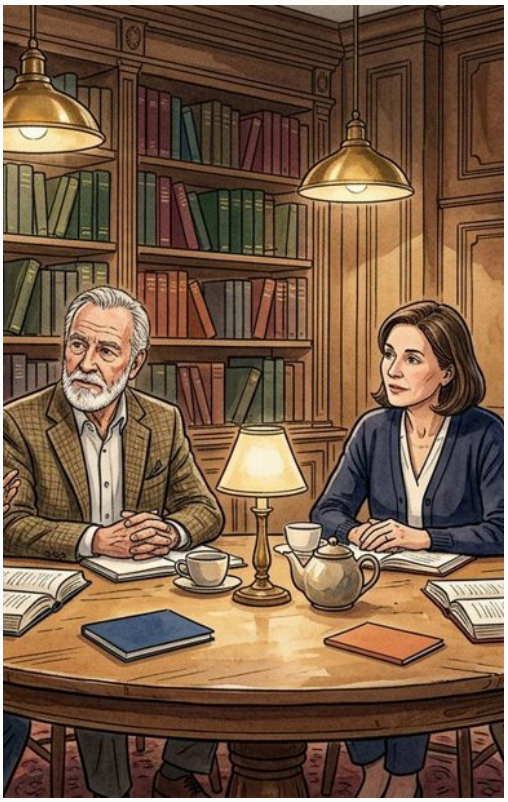


Figure 1 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

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# Agree on the important terms.

Arguments become difficult to compare when speakers use the same word in different ways. Define the terms needed for this discussion before collecting reasons.

Shared text could mean one extract for one meeting, not a permanent reading rule. Choice could refer to selecting among three extracts rather than unrestricted material.

## Term / working meaning / excluded meaning

Working record: Define shared, choice and useful for this particular exercise. Keep your first attempt and your revised version so the change remains visible.

**Term**

Write your term here.

**working meaning**

Write your working meaning here.

**excluded meaning**

Write your excluded meaning here.

*Define shared, choice and useful for this particular exercise.*

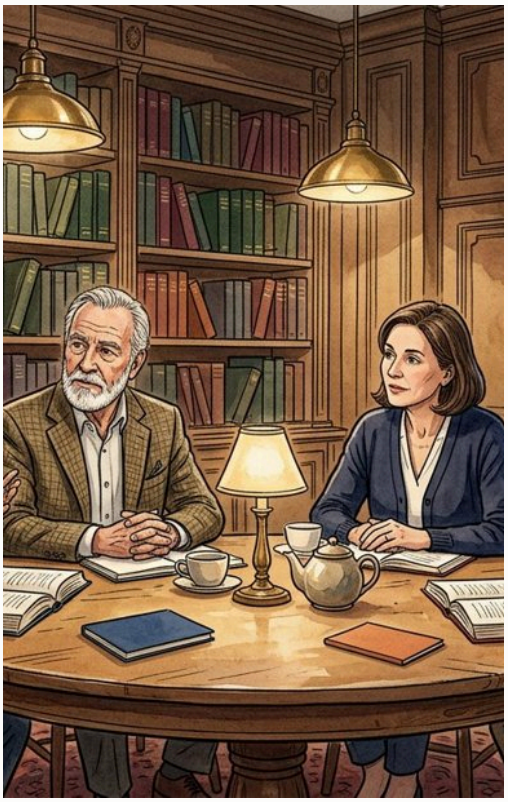


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# Map a claim to its reasons.

State a claim, the reason offered for it and the assumption connecting them. A reason is not yet evidence, and the connecting assumption may be disputed.

Claim: one extract could focus the conversation. Reason: everyone can refer to the same passage. Assumption: a common reference is helpful for the intended discussion.

## Claim / reason / connecting assumption

Working record: Build a three-part argument without claiming an observed learning outcome. Keep your first attempt and your revised version so the change remains visible.

**Claim**

Write your claim here.

**reason**

Write your reason here.

**connecting assumption**

Write your connecting assumption here.

*Build a three-part argument without claiming an observed learning outcome.*

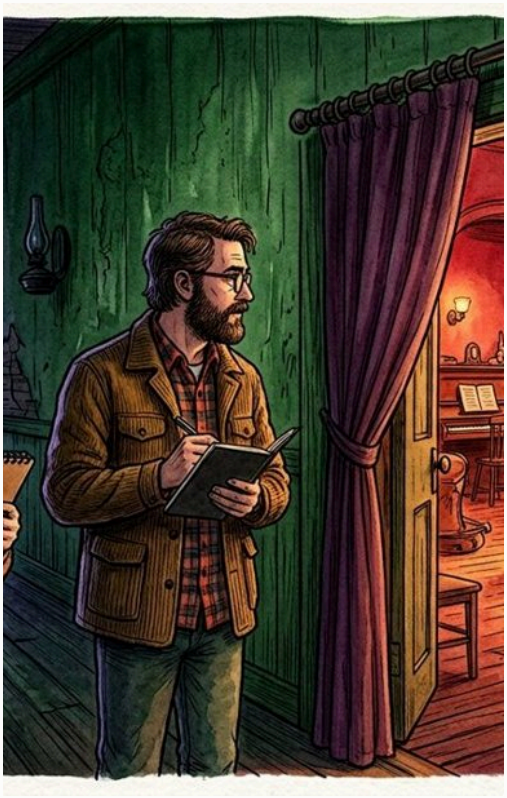


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# Support the first position.

Develop the strongest bounded version of the shared-text argument. Separate a plausible mechanism from information that would be needed to establish it in practice.

A common passage may make references easier to locate. Whether that actually helps a particular group remains a question requiring suitable observation and participant context.

## Supporting reason / mechanism / evidence needed

Working record: Write one strong supporting reason and the source needed to test its relevance. Keep your first attempt and your revised version so the change remains visible.

**Supporting reason**

Write your supporting reason here.

**mechanism**

Write your mechanism here.

**evidence needed**

Write your evidence needed here.

*Write one strong supporting reason and the source needed to test its relevance.*



Figure 2 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

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# Represent the alternative fairly.

Build a version of the multiple-choice argument that its supporter would recognise. Do not weaken it simply to make your preferred position easier to defend.

Choice might let readers connect discussion to their interests. It could also make references harder to share. Both points belong in an honest comparison.

## Alternative claim / strongest reason / acknowledged cost

Working record: Write the alternative argument before adding your response. Keep your first attempt and your revised version so the change remains visible.

**Alternative claim**

Write your alternative claim here.

**strongest reason**

Write your strongest reason here.

**acknowledged cost**

Write your acknowledged cost here.

*Write the alternative argument before adding your response.*



Figure 3 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

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# Evaluate a source before using it.

Ask whether a source addresses the actual question, how it was produced and what it cannot establish. This exercise supplies no real empirical study.

A fictional preference quote can illustrate a viewpoint but cannot establish what most readers prefer. A beautiful illustration is not evidence about reading outcomes.

## Source type / relevance / limit / permitted use

Working record: Classify an invented quotation and explain the narrow use you would allow. Keep your first attempt and your revised version so the change remains visible.

**Source type**

Write your source type here.

**relevance**

Write your relevance here.

**limit**

Write your limit here.

**permitted use**

Write your permitted use here.

*Classify an invented quotation and explain the narrow use you would allow.*

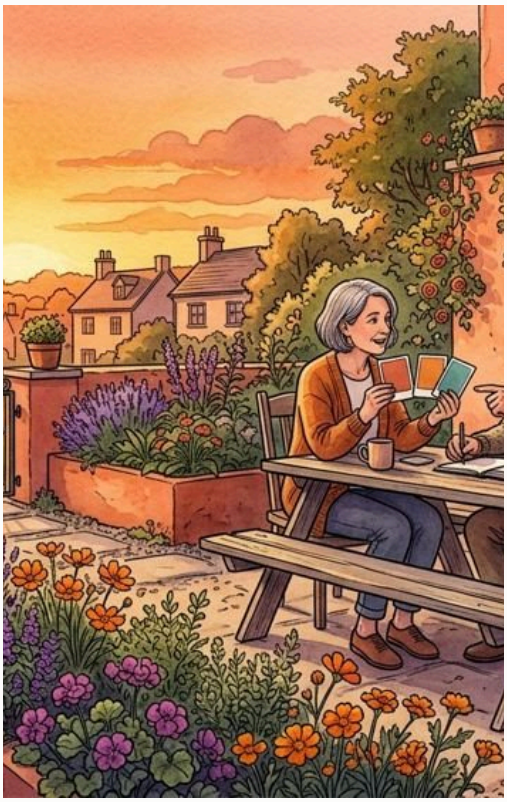


Figure 3 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

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# Ask a question that could matter.

A useful challenge targets an assumption or a missing link rather than the speaker’s character. Give the other person room to clarify the argument.

Question: does the benefit of a common reference depend on the kind of discussion?

That asks for a condition rather than assuming that the original claim is foolish.

## Target claim / questioned assumption / clarification request

Working record: Write two respectful challenges addressed to different parts of the argument. Keep your first attempt and your revised version so the change remains visible.

**Target claim**

Write your target claim here.

**questioned assumption**

Write your questioned assumption here.

**clarification request**

Write your clarification request here.

*Write two respectful challenges addressed to different parts of the argument.*

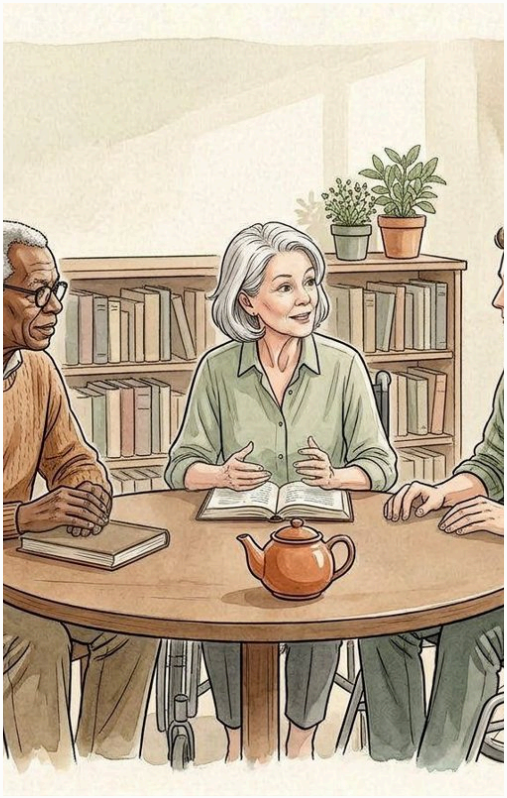


Figure 4 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

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# Respond without changing the subject.

A response should identify the challenge, answer the part you can address and acknowledge what remains unresolved. It is acceptable to narrow the original claim.

A revised response might say a shared extract could help a close-reading exercise, while a broader discussion might benefit from several choices. The claim is now more conditional.

## Challenge / response / qualification / unresolved issue

Working record: Answer one question and add a qualification that genuinely changes the claim. Keep your first attempt and your revised version so the change remains visible.

**Challenge**

Write your challenge here.

**response**

Write your response here.

**qualification**

Write your qualification here.

**unresolved issue**

Write your unresolved issue here.

*Answer one question and add a qualification that genuinely changes the claim.*

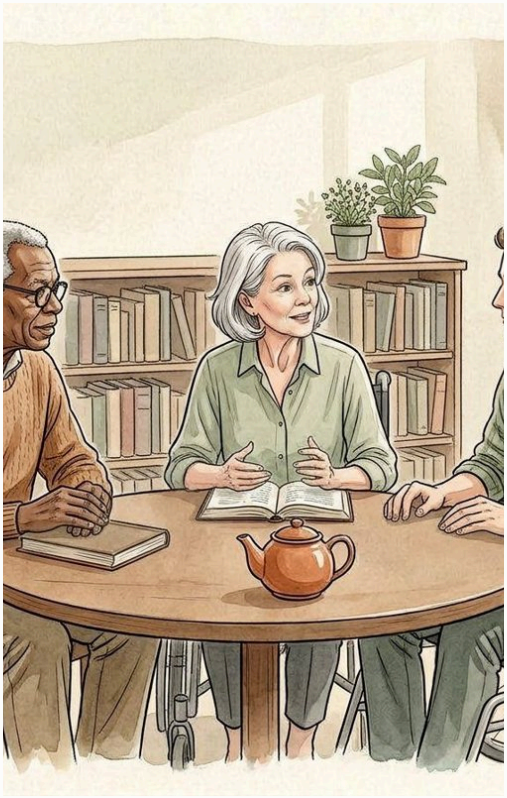


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# Revise the argument map.

Update the claim, reasons and assumptions together. If the claim becomes narrower, check that the supporting reasons still address the revised version.

Replace one text is best with one shared extract may suit a session focused on close comparison.

The revision concerns task fit rather than a universal ranking.

## Earlier claim / revised claim / retained reason / removed assumption

Working record: Revise the map and cross out a reason that no longer fits. Keep your first attempt and your revised version so the change remains visible.

**Earlier claim**

Write your earlier claim here.

**revised claim**

Write your revised claim here.

**retained reason**

Write your retained reason here.

**removed assumption**

Write your removed assumption here.

*Revise the map and cross out a reason that no longer fits.*



Figure 5 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

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# State a provisional position.

Finish with the position you can currently support, its strongest reason and a condition that could change your view. A provisional position is not a failure to decide.

For this invented close-reading session, a shared extract is a defensible starting option.

Information about the actual group, purpose and materials could change that choice.

## Position / reason / condition / open question

Working record: Write a closing position that leaves its evidence boundary visible. Keep your first attempt and your revised version so the change remains visible.

**Position**

Write your position here.

**reason**

Write your reason here.

**condition**

Write your condition here.

**open question**

Write your open question here.

*Write a closing position that leaves its evidence boundary visible.*



Figure 5 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json